

**Protest button**

The "Free Calley" movement believed that the lieutenant had been unfairly blamed for the orders of those higher up in the chain of command. They made a hero of him, holding rallies and writing songs in his honor.

The Pentagon Papers

My Lai tarnished the reputation of the Army and shocked the American public. "No My Lai" became a key mantra for infantry officers in the US Army. Other questions were also being raised about US conduct of the war. On June 23, 1971, the *New York Times* began publishing excerpts from a secret record of the Department of Defense. These "Pentagon Papers" revealed shallow motivations behind important military decisions. Although Nixon tried to quash public access to the report, the damage was already done.